A-A-53372
5 February 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

FORCEPS, SUTURE, Tying (Troutman)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description as a replacement for Military Specification MIL-F-42038(DM), dated 10 March 1987, which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers an eye suture forceps suitable for microsurgery.

Salient characteristics:

General. The eye suture forceps shall be suitable for tying suture.

Style and design. The forceps shall be of straight design, have very fine points at the tips, and shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing No. 23382. Forceps shall have non-locking jaws which mesh properly when closed. Forceps shall have handle serrations providing a gripping surface.

Material. Forceps shall be fabricated of Class 4 corrosion-resistant steel in accordance with ASTM F899.

Hardness. Forceps shall have a Rockwell hardness of C-40 to C-45 when tested in accordance with ASTM E18, or E92 and E140.

Boil test. The forceps shall meet the boil test requirements specified in Federal Specification GG-I-526.

Copper sulfate test. The forceps shall meet the copper sulfate test requirements specified in GG-I-526.

Passivation. Forceps shall be properly passivated.

Finish. Forceps shall have a mirror or satin finish.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515
DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Markings. The forceps shall bear the manufacturer's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Instruments of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufacture.

Workmanship. The forceps shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

PRODUCT QUALITY LEVEL.

Visual and dimensional examination. Shall be examined to verify that the design, construction and workmanship are in accordance with applicable requirements.

Materials. The supplier shall be responsible for assuring that materials are in accordance with requirements specified.

Unit. Each (EA). One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances of procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Certificate of quality. Certificate of quality supplied by the manufacturer of the steel may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of composition testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contractor number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number, the item identification, the lot number, the size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasable, the sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The unit of product for tests purposes shall be one forceps. Inspection level shall be S-1 an AQL of 1.0, except for chemical compostion where acceptance number shall be zero.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subscontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-127-2209	FORCEPS, SUTURE, Tying (Troutman)

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4145

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATES

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO 4966 Alexandria, VA

POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY

Commander
Defense Personnel Support Center
ATTN: DPSC-RSTS
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania 19101-8419

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53372	FORCEPS, SUTURE, Tying (Troutman)

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)* _____

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording

b. Recommended Wording

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

DD FORM 82 MAR 1426 PREVIOUS EDITION IS OBSOLETE

Source: https://assist.dla.mil - Downloaded: 2026-10-26T09:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.